WE ARE M&C SAATCHI PERFORMANCE

WE CONNECT YOUR BRAND TO TODAY'S CONNECTED CONSUMERS

Rakuten

Rakuten

RAKUTEN: TESTING CREATIVE OPTIMIZATION ON TIKTOK

Rakuten is one of the leading Cash Back and shopping rewards apps in the U.S. Members can access over 3,500 retailers across every shopping category, including big brands like Nike, Adidas, Sephora, ULTA Beauty, Levi's, Calvin Klein, Ray-Ban, and more.

The app is simple to use – customers simply click through retailers on the Rakuten app and then shop on the stores' websites, Cash Back is applied to purchases at checkout. Shoppers can earn up to 15% cash back on product purchased via Rakuten depending on the deals available. In addition, membership to the Rakuten Rewards loyalty program is free and new members can receive a $10 welcome bonus after placing a qualifying purchase within the first 90 days.

Rakuten became a client for M&C Saatchi Performance in 2021, at that time a new Influencer Performance Marketing division was established at the agency to help clients such as Rakuten Rewards harness the power of content creators via performance media channels.

We proposed running influencer campaigns on TikTok specifically as a way of reaching new audiences through a native format that would resonate with the community. The creative produced via these campaigns is published organically and those that experience high engagement are then selected for paid media to generate new app installs and new users.

This approach has proven so successful for Rakuten (and other clients) that it has became an evergreen performance media strategy for the brand. The M&C Saatchi Performance team are now so trusted, they create new approaches based on seasonality and trends seen on TikTok to continue keeping the brand relevant even during times when consumer spending may be low.

The M&C Saatchi Performance team are always looking to optimize for clients, and therefore a creative optimization testing plan was developed in Spring 2023 to further test and optimize campaigns against KPIs.

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RAKUTEN: TESTING CREATIVE OPTIMIZATION ON TIKTOK

THE BRIEF:

Develop and test new creative which results in improved customer acquisition costs.

THE CHALLENGE:

TikTok requires frequent refreshing of creative, much faster than other platforms. We're testing new strategies such as Automatic Creative Optimization to ensure campaigns adhere to best practices.

THE STRATEGY:

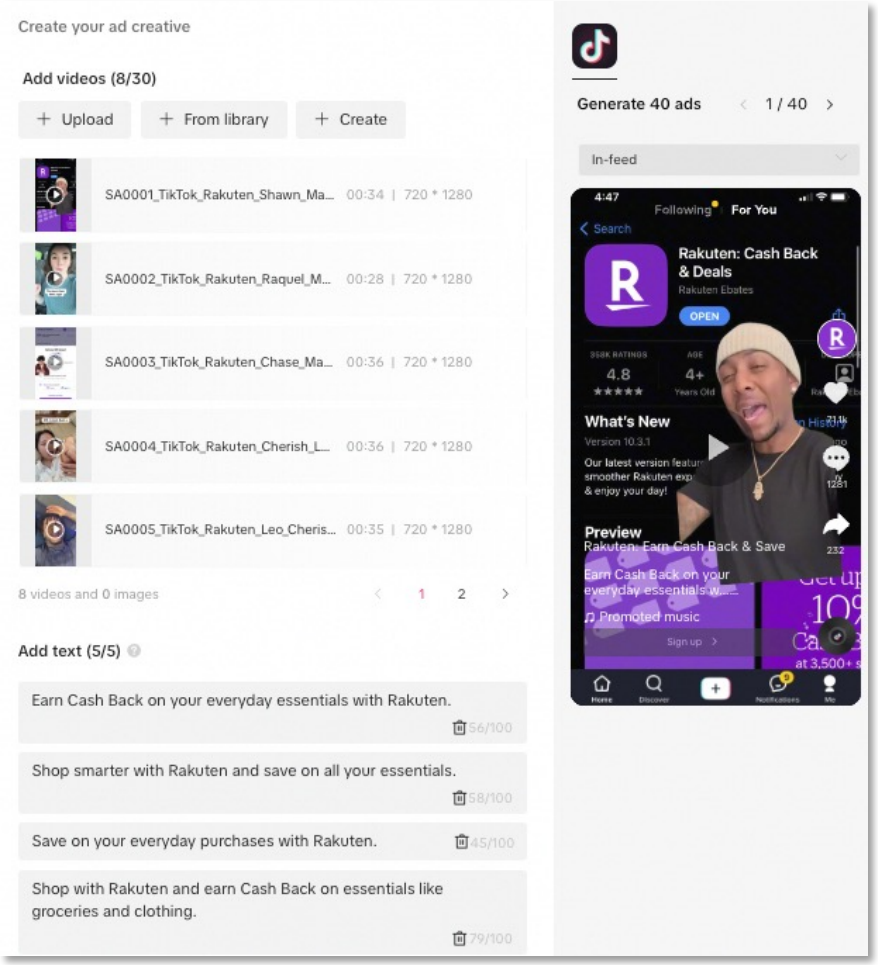
For this campaign, the approach was to work directly with TikTok's verified creative partners via the TikTok Creative Exchange program in order to build assets with a verified creative agency.

In previous campaigns the strategy has been to utilize Spark ads to boost content from Influencer accounts. In this campaign the media was applied to boost content from the Rakuten brand handle using creators to create the content.

With the opportunity to promote assets on TikTok from the Rakuten account handle, the M&C Saatchi Performance team tested a new campaign optimization technique called Automatic Creative Optimization, which enabled the option to test **all** versions of copy against **all** video assets, combining all assets together to find a winning solution.

The technique enabled the testing of over 40 permutations of the creative assets and found one stand out pairing that drove scalable performance for the campaign.

AUTOMATIC CREATIVE OPTIMIZATION:



WHAT IS AUTOMATIC CREATIVE OPTIMIZATION?

Automated Creative Optimization is a tool from TikTok that automates ad creation and testing processes. This enables advertisers to be very efficient, not just in saving time creating ads, but also testing which ads deliver the best performance. The tool enables advertisers to automate testing, ensuring the highest performing creative combinations of creative assets to come to the surface.

HOW IT WORKS

Upload images, video, ad copy and Call to Actions. The Automated Creative Optimization tool then combines these assets into multiple ad variations. These ad variations are put head-to-head to find the optimal combination of asset variations. The best creative combination based on the results of the tested combinations can then be identified and iterated on.

The testing of the variations happens without the need for manual intervention, so that the best performing creatives are produced and served.

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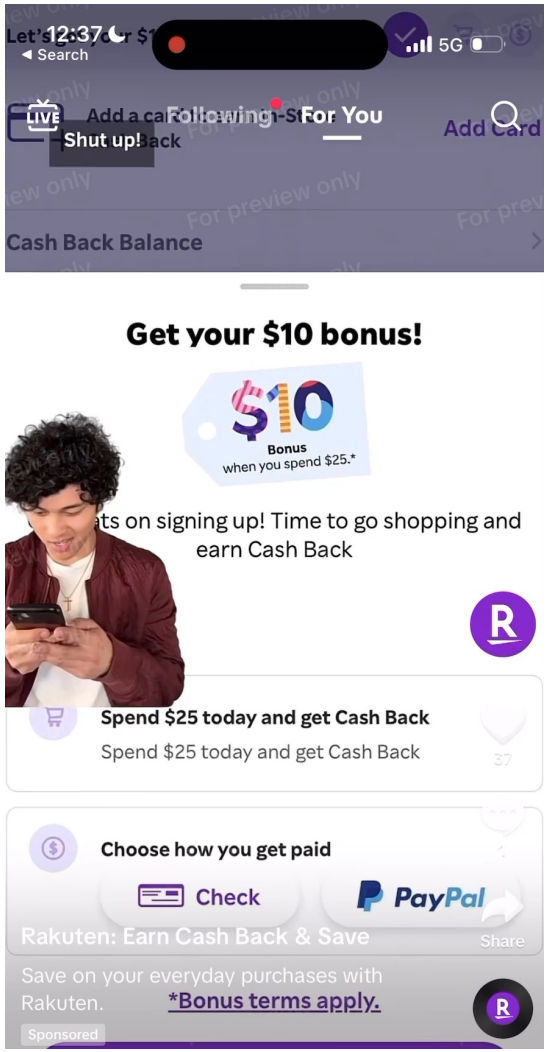
CREATIVE TESTING EXAMPLES:

Combinations of images, video, ad copy and CTA's were combined to produce the best performing versions.

The technique enabled the testing of over 40 permutations of the creative assets and found one stand out pairing that drove scalable performance for the campaign.



Rakuten

TIKTOK IMPROVEMENTS

+35%

REDUCTION IN COST PER INSTALL

-31%

REDUCTION IN COST PER ACQUISITION

(VIA REGISTRATIONS)

+77%

INCREASE IN SKAN CLICK CONVERSION RATE

April to May 2023

M&C SAATCHI PERFORMANCE

TALK TO US

Contact us for more information
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